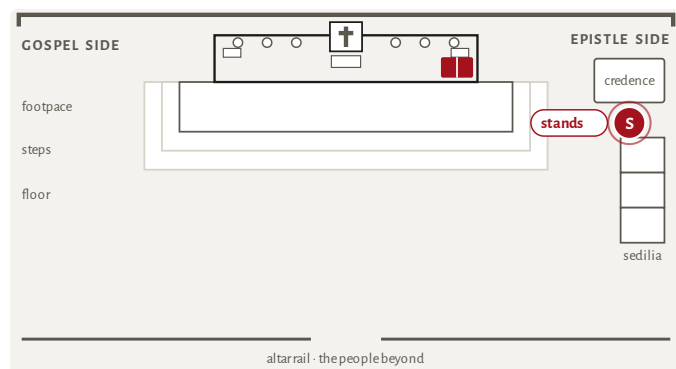


● you ● priest, deacon, subdeacon ● other servers - - -> where you walk → carrying the missal ◇ genuflect ■ missal ● bell

triangle: the way a figure faces

One server does everything: answers every response, moves the missal, brings the cruets and rings the bell.



BEFORE MASS

1 Get the credence and the altar ready

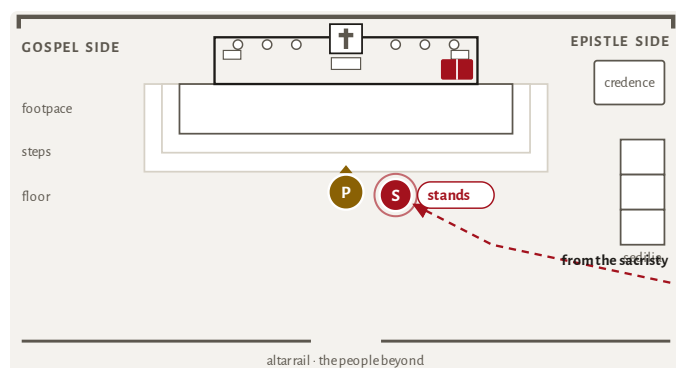
You stand at the credence.

1. Vest in cassock and surplice.
2. Set out on the credence: the wine and water cruets, the dish and towel for washing the priest's fingers, the small bell, and the Communion paten.
3. Light the two candles used at Low Mass, the Epistle side first.
4. Check that the missal is closed on its stand at the Epistle side, unless you are to carry it in.
5. Help the priest vest.

The rubric pictures you carrying the missal in ahead of the priest and back out afterwards. In many churches it waits on the altar instead.

You never open the missal or turn its pages at Low Mass. The priest does that himself (S.R.C. 3448).

Customs at the sacristy door: holy water, and a bell rung as you go out to tell the people Mass is starting.



BEFORE MASS

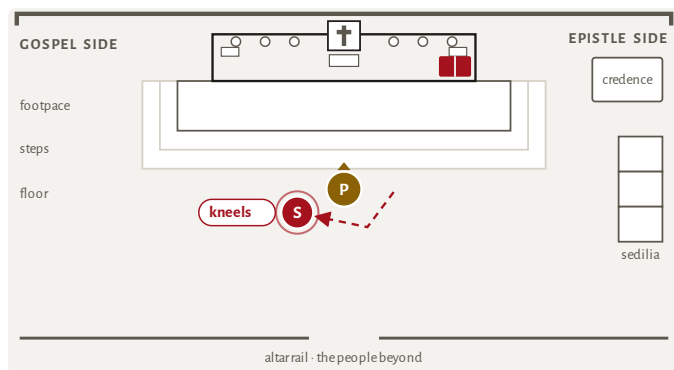
2 Lead the priest to the altar

You stand at the priest's right, at the foot of the altar.

1. Bow with the priest to the cross in the sacristy, then walk in front of him to the altar.
2. At the foot of the altar stand at his right. When he hands you his biretta, take it: kiss first his hand, then the biretta.
3. Genuflect on the floor when he genuflects. If there is no tabernacle he only bows, but you still genuflect.
4. Put the biretta on the sedilia (Fortescue: the credence, or another convenient place).

The kisses (the *solita oscula*) are left out at Requiems and when the Blessed Sacrament is exposed. In 1920 Fortescue noted that lay servers in England usually skipped them; current guides keep them.

You genuflect every time you pass the middle of the altar, whether or not the Blessed Sacrament is there (S.R.C., 16 November 1906).



PRAYERS AT THE FOOT OF THE ALTAR

3 Kneel behind the priest and begin

You kneel on the floor behind the priest, to his left.

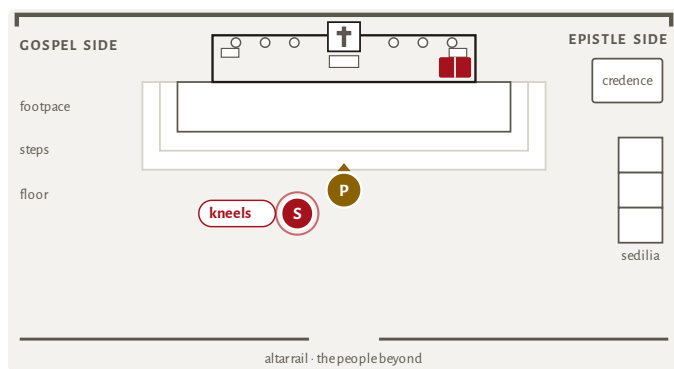
1. Come back to the Gospel side of the middle. When the priest comes down to the floor and makes his reverence, kneel behind him, to his left.
2. Kneel on the floor itself, not on the step.
3. Sign yourself with him at *In nómine Patris*.

PRIEST ✠ In nómine Patris, ...

PRIEST Introíbo ad altáre Dei.

YOU **Ad Deum qui lætíficat iuventútem meam.**

The rubric: "the server, kneeling behind him to his left" (*minister retro post eum ad sinistram genuflexus*, Rit. serv. III.6).



PRAYERS AT THE FOOT OF THE ALTAR

4 Answer Psalm 42, verse by verse

You kneel on the floor behind the priest, to his left.

1. Say every other verse: the priest says one, you say the next.
2. Bow your head at *Glória Patri*.

PRIEST Iúdica me, Deus, et ...

YOU **Quia tu es, Deus, fortitúdo mea: quare me repulísti, et quare tristis incédo, dum afflígit me inimícus?**

PRIEST Emítte lucem tuam et ...

YOU **Et introíbo ad altáre Dei: ad Deum qui lætíficat iuventútem meam.**

PRIEST Confitébor tibi in cíthara, ...

YOU **Spera in Deo, quóniam adhuc confitébor illi: salutáre vultus mei, et Deus meus.**

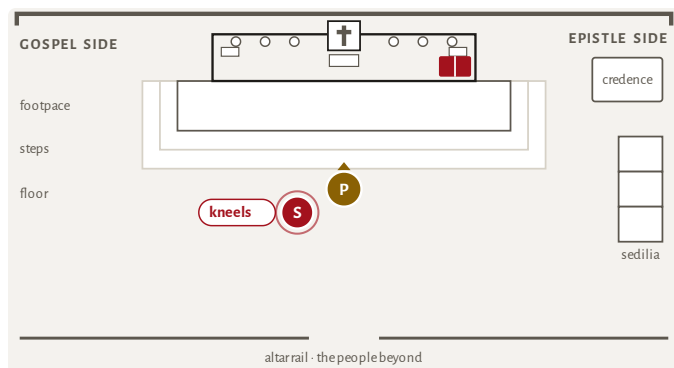
PRIEST Glória Patri, et Fílio, ...

YOU **Sicut erat in princípío, et nunc, et semper: et in sácula sæculórum. Amen.**

PRIEST Introíbo ad altáre Dei.

YOU **Ad Deum qui lætíficat iuventútem meam.**

Left out at Requiems, and from Passion Sunday to Maundy Thursday in Masses of the season. Then you answer the first *Introíbo* and the priest goes straight on to *Adiutórium nostrum* (Rit. serv. III.6; Code n. 425). A feast that falls in Passiontide keeps the psalm.



PRAYERS AT THE FOOT OF THE ALTAR

5 Answer the priest's Confiteor

You kneel on the floor behind the priest, to his left.

1. Sign yourself with the priest at *Adiutórium nostrum*.
2. While he bows low and says his Confiteor, kneel upright. Do not bow.
3. Then, turned a little toward him and bowing slightly, say the *Misereátur*.

PRIEST ✠ *Adiutórium nostrum in nómine Dómini.*

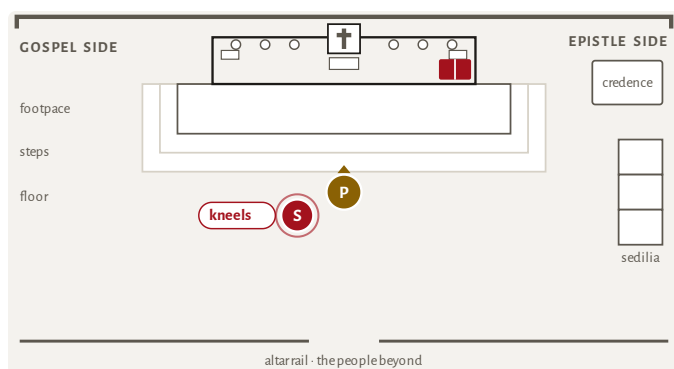
YOU **Qui fecit cælum et terram.**

PRIEST Confiteor Deo omnipoténti

YOU **Misereátur tui omnipotens Deus, et, dimíssis peccátis tuis, perdúcat te ad vitam ætérrnam.**

PRIEST Amen.

How deep to bow at the *Misereátur* differs: slightly (Fortescue), moderately (Biretta Books card), profoundly (FSSP Omaha). Do what your church does.



PRAYERS AT THE FOOT OF THE ALTAR

6 Say the Confiteor

You kneel on the floor behind the priest, to his left.

1. Bow low toward the altar and say the Confiteor.
2. At *tibi, pater* and *te, pater*, turn a little toward the priest.
3. Strike your breast three times at *mea culpa, mea culpa, mea máxima culpa*.
4. Stay bowed while the priest says *Misereátur vestri*, and answer *Amen*.
5. Straighten up and sign yourself at *Indulgéntiam*, and answer *Amen*.

YOU **Confíteor Deo omnipoténti, beátæ Mariæ semper Vírgini, beáto Michaéli Archángelo, beáto Ioánni Baptístæ, sanctis Apóstolis Petro et Paulo, ómnibus Sanctis, et tibi, pater: quia peccávi nimis cogitatióne, verbo et ópere: mea culpa, mea culpa, mea máxima culpa. Ideo precor beátam Mariám semper Vírginem, beátum Michaélem Archángelum, beátum Ioánnem Baptístam, sanctos Apóstolos Petrum et Paulum, omnes Sanctos, et te, pater, oráre pro me ad Dóminum Deum nostrum.**

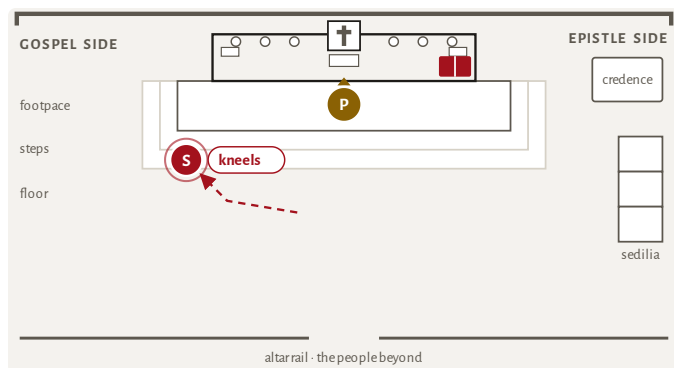
PRIEST *Misereátur vestri omnípotens Deus, ...*

YOU **Amen.**

PRIEST ✠ *Indulgéntiam, absolutiónem et ...*

YOU **Amen.**

The rubric for the turn: those answering "say *tibi, pater* and *te, pater* turned a little toward the celebrant" (Rit. serv. III.9). The Missal prints only the priest's Confiteor, with the rule that the servers say *tibi, pater* and *te, pater* where he says *vobis, fratres* and *vos, fratres*.



PRAYERS AT THE FOOT OF THE ALTAR

7 Answer the versicles, then kneel at the Gospel side

You kneel on the lowest step at the Gospel end.

1. Bow slightly from *Deus, tu convérsus*, and stay bowed until the priest goes up to the altar.
2. As he goes up, rise. You may lift the front of his alb as he climbs the steps.
3. Go to the Gospel end of the lowest step and kneel there.

PRIEST Deus, tu convérsus vivificábis nos.

YOU **Et plebs tua lætábitur in te.**

PRIEST Osténde nobis, Dómine, misericórdiam tuam.

YOU **Et salutáre tuum da nobis.**

PRIEST Dómine, exáudi oratióem meam.

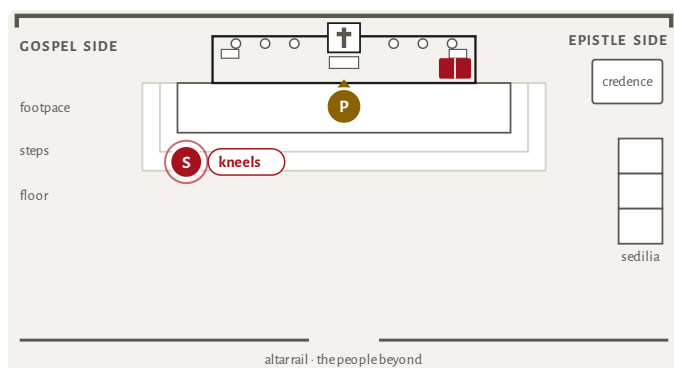
YOU **Et clamor meus ad te véniat.**

PRIEST Dóminus vobíscum.

YOU **Et cum spírítu tuo.**

PRIEST Orémus.

From here on your place is kneeling on the lowest step, on the side opposite the missal. The missal is on the Epistle side, so you kneel at the Gospel side.



MASS OF THE CATECHUMENS

8 Introit and Kyrie

You kneel on the lowest step at the Gospel end.

1. Sign yourself when the priest begins the Introit at the missal (not at a Requiem, where he signs the book instead).
2. Alternate the Kyrie with him at the middle: he says the first, third, fifth, seventh and ninth; you say the others.

PRIEST Kýrie, eléison.

YOU **Kýrie, eléison.**

PRIEST Kýrie, eléison.

YOU **Christe, eléison.**

PRIEST Christe, eléison.

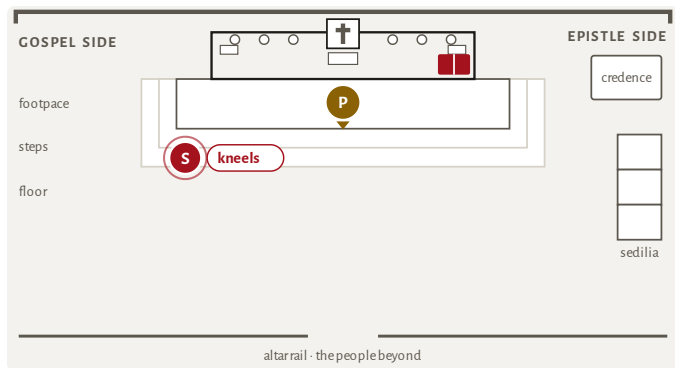
YOU **Christe, eléison.**

PRIEST Kýrie, eléison.

YOU **Kýrie, eléison.**

PRIEST Kýrie, eléison.

If nobody answers, the priest says all nine himself (Rit. serv. IV.2).



MASS OF THE CATECHUMENS

9 Gloria and the collects

You kneel on the lowest step at the Gospel end.

1. The priest says the Gloria alone, when the day has one. Bow your head at the Holy Name, and sign yourself at the last words, *Cum Sancto Spíritu*.
2. When he turns and says *Dóminus vobíscum*, answer.
3. Answer *Amen* at the end of the first collect and of the last one: the ones that finish *per ómnia sæcula sæculórum*.

PRIEST Dóminus vobíscum.

YOU Et cum spíritu tuo.

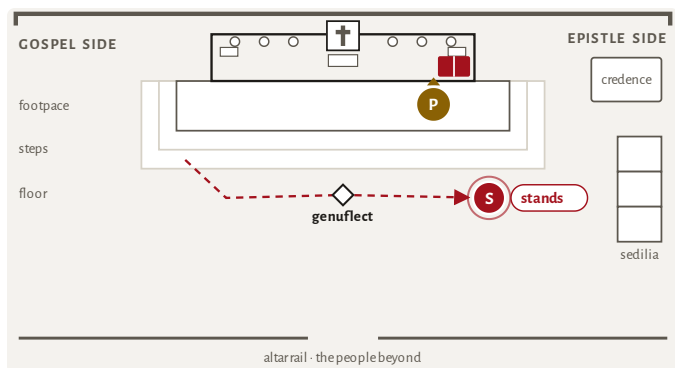
PRIEST ... per ómnia sæcula sæculórum.

YOU Amen.

No Gloria in violet Masses or at Requiems (Code n. 432). Then *Dóminus vobíscum* follows the Kyrie at once.

On Ember days and other days with *Flectámus gēnua*, the priest has said both *Flectámus gēnua* and *Leváte* himself since 1960. Stay kneeling and say nothing (Code n. 440). Older books give *Leváte* to the server.

On days with several lessons, answer *Deo grátias* after each one and stay in your place until the last.



MASS OF THE CATECHUMENS

10 Answer the Epistle, then go to the Epistle corner

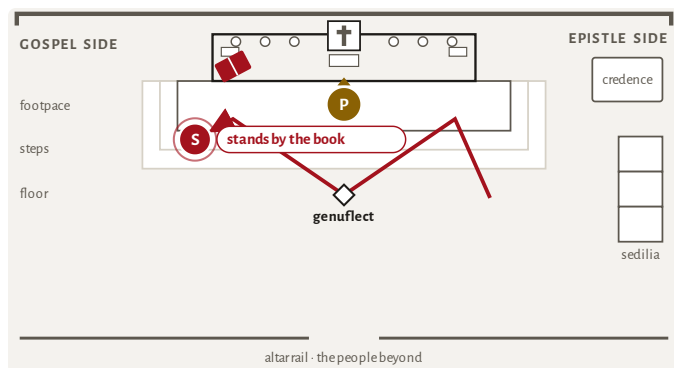
You stand on the floor at the Epistle corner.

1. At the end of the Epistle answer *Deo grátias*. The priest usually gives a sign: he lays his left hand on the altar, or turns or lifts his hand toward you.
2. Rise and go along the floor to the Epistle side, genuflecting at the middle. Do not walk across the footpace.
3. Stand on the floor near the priest, a little behind him to his right, while he reads the Gradual (or Alleluia, Tract or Sequence).

PRIEST at the end of the Epistle

YOU Deo grátias.

With a long Sequence, such as the *Dies iræ* at a Requiem, wait until it is nearly finished before you move.



MASS OF THE CATECHUMENS

11 Carry the missal to the Gospel side

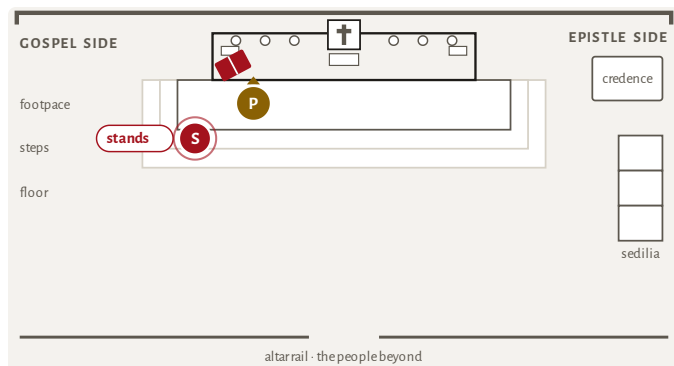
You end up on the step below the footpace, beside the missal.

1. When the priest goes to the middle of the altar (to say *Munda cor meum*), go up the side steps at the Epistle corner and take the missal with its stand.
2. Come down to the floor in the middle and genuflect, holding the book.
3. Go up at the Gospel side and set the missal at the Gospel corner, turned at an angle: the back of the book toward the corner, the pages facing the middle of the altar (about 45°).
4. Step down to the step below the footpace and stand there, facing the book.

The rubric lets either the priest or the server carry it, and fixes the angle: "so that the back of the book faces that side of the altar, and not the wall" (Rit. serv. VI.1).

Its words about bowing to the cross while passing the middle describe the priest walking along the altar with the book. Crossing on the floor, you genuflect, as at every crossing.

Small differences: the Canons Regular bow to the cross before coming down; the Biretta Books card has you bow to the priest; FSSP Omaha does neither.



MASS OF THE CATECHUMENS

12 Stand by the book for the start of the Gospel

You stand on the step below the footpace, beside the missal.

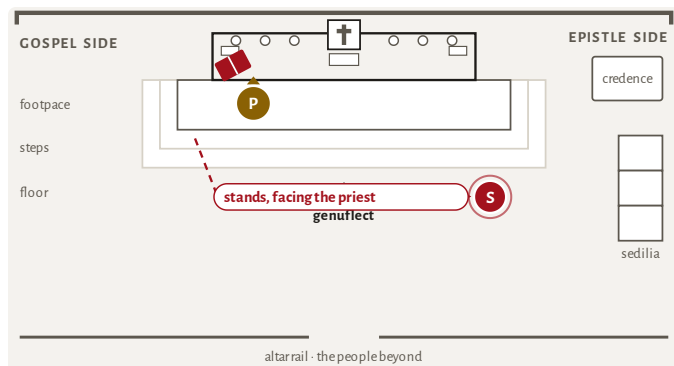
1. Answer the greeting.
2. At *Sequéntia sancti Evangélii*, with the priest, make three small crosses with your right thumb: on your forehead, lips and breast.

PRIEST Dóminus vobíscum.

YOU Et cum spírítu tuo.

PRIEST ✠ Sequéntia sancti Evangélii secúndum N.

YOU Glória tibi, Dómine.



MASS OF THE CATECHUMENS

13 Cross to the Epistle side for the Gospel

You stand on the floor at the Epistle corner.

1. Go down, cross to the Epistle side (genuflecting at the middle) and stand on the floor there, turned toward the priest.
2. If the priest genuflects during the Gospel, genuflect with him.
3. At the end answer *Laus tibi, Christe*.
4. Then kneel at the Epistle end of the lowest step.

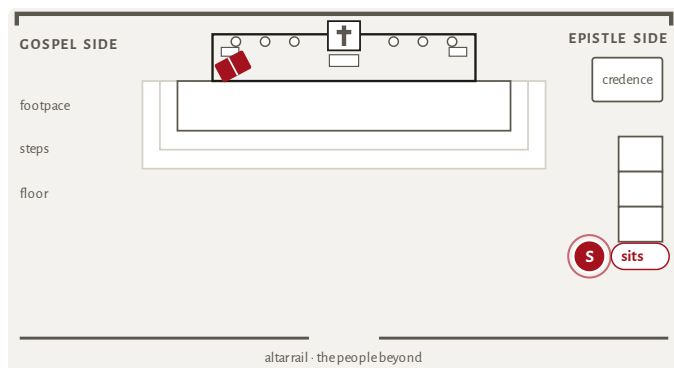
PRIEST at the end of the Gospel

YOU Laus tibi, Christe.

The rubric puts you here: "standing at the Epistle side, below the lowest step of the altar" (Rit. serv. VI.2).

Custom in current guides: before you leave the book, wait for the Holy Name in the opening lines and bow.

At a Requiem the priest does not kiss the book, so answer as soon as he finishes.



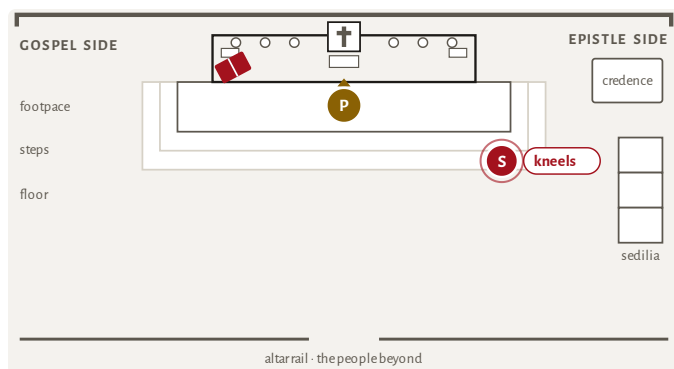
MASS OF THE CATECHUMENS

14 If there is a sermon

You sit on a stool by the sedilia.

1. Genuflect with the priest at the middle, then sit at the sedilia or on a stool.
2. Stand if the Gospel is read again in English.
3. Afterwards genuflect with him again and go back to kneel at the Epistle end of the lowest step.

The rubric only says a short homily may follow the Gospel, especially on Sundays and feasts (Code n. 474). Where you sit and when you stand come from current practice: ask your MC.



MASS OF THE CATECHUMENS

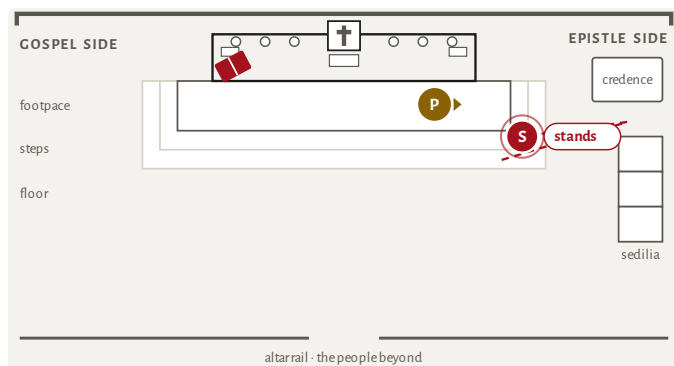
15 Kneel for the Creed, when it is said

You kneel on the lowest step at the Epistle end.

1. Kneel at the Epistle end of the lowest step.
2. Bow your head at *Deum, Iesum Christum* and *simul adorátur*.
3. Bow low while the priest genuflects at *Et incarnátus est... et homo factus est*.
4. Sign yourself at the last words, *Et vitam ventúri saeculi*.
5. No Creed today? Then the Offertory follows at once: be kneeling and ready to fetch the cruets.

Kneeling for the Creed is the server's "undoubted rule" (S.R.C. 2915, as Fortescue reports), even where the people stand.

The Creed is said on Sundays, first-class feasts and some others (Code nn. 475–476).



OFFERTORY

16 Bring the cruets

You stand on the step below the footpace at the Epistle corner.

1. When the priest says *Dóminus vobíscum* and *Orémus*, answer, then go to the credence.
2. Take the wine cruet in your right hand and the water cruet in your left.
3. Wait at the Epistle corner, on the step below the footpace.
4. When the priest comes, bow. Kiss the wine cruet and hand it to him.
5. Move the water cruet to your right hand and take back the wine cruet with your left. Hand him the water; he pours only a little himself.
6. Take the water cruet back, bow, and return both to the credence.

PRIEST Dóminus vobíscum.

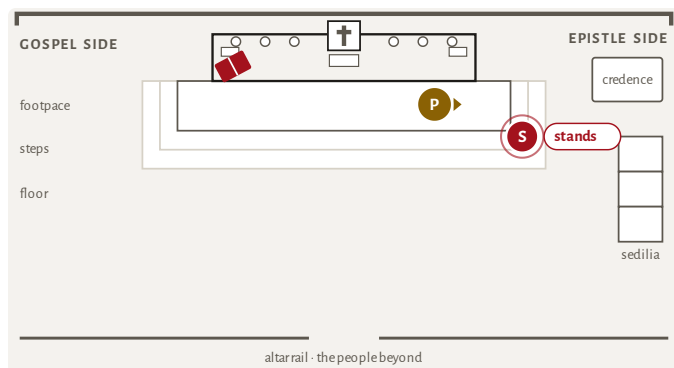
YOU Et cum spírítu tuo.

PRIEST Orémus.

The rubric: the server "kisses the cruet itself, not the hand of the celebrant" (Rit. serv. VII.4). It names only the wine cruet. Kissing both cruets, as you give them and as they come back, is Fortescue's practice and the current guides'.

No kisses at a Requiem.

Local customs here: one ring of the bell as the priest unveils the chalice (Canons Regular), or going up to fold the chalice veil (FSSP Omaha). Ask your MC.



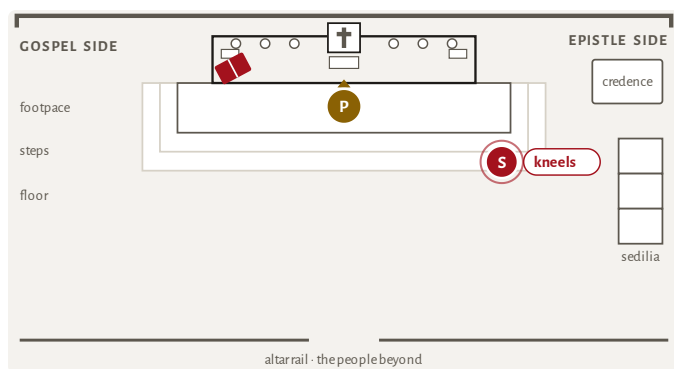
OFFERTORY

17 Wash the priest's fingers

You stand on the step below the footpace at the Epistle corner.

1. Put the towel over your left forearm, and take the dish in your left hand and the water cruet in your right.
2. Bow, then pour a little water over the priest's fingertips so that it falls into the dish.
3. Offer him the towel, take it back, and bow.
4. Put everything back on the credence and kneel at the Epistle end of the lowest step.

The rubric: "the server pouring the water, he washes his hands, that is, the tips of the thumb and index finger" (Rit. serv. VII.6).



OFFERTORY

18 Answer the Orate, fratres

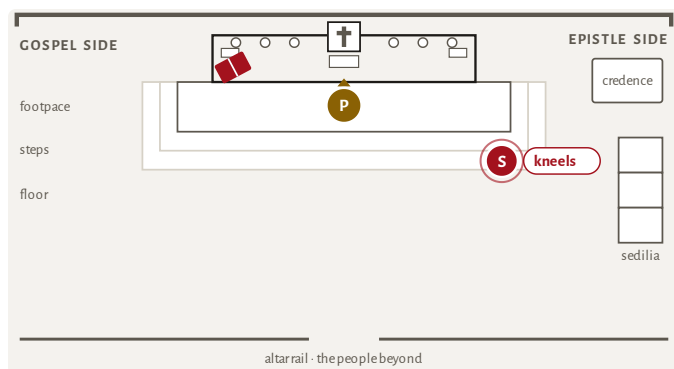
You kneel on the lowest step at the Epistle end.

1. The priest turns to the people and says *Oráte, fratres*. Wait until he has turned back to the altar.
2. Then, bowing, answer the *Suscípiat*.

PRIEST Oráte, fratres: ut meum ...

YOU **Suscípiat Dóminus sacrificium de mánibus tuis ad laudem et glóriam nóminis sui, ad utilitátem quoque nostram, totiúsque Ecclésiæ suæ sanctæ.**

If there is no server, the priest answers it himself, saying *de mánibus meis* (Rit. serv. VII.7).



OFFERTORY

19 Answer the dialogue before the Preface

You kneel on the lowest step at the Epistle end.

1. Answer each line. The priest then reads the Preface.

PRIEST Per ómnia sácula sæculórum.

YOU **Amen.**

PRIEST Dóminus vobíscum.

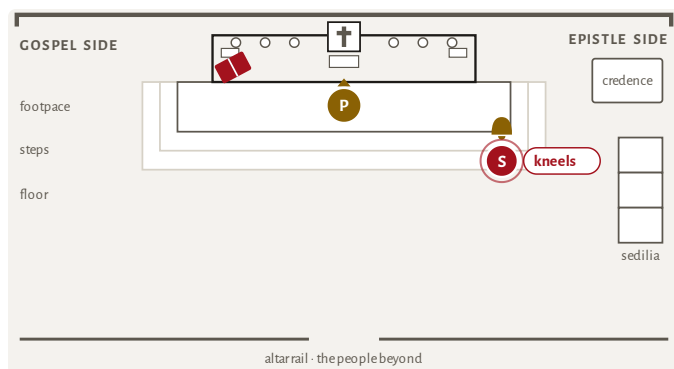
YOU **Et cum spírítu tuo.**

PRIEST Sursum corda.

YOU **Habémus ad Dóminum.**

PRIEST Grátias agámus Dómino Deo nostro.

YOU **Dignum et iustum est.**



SANCTUS AND CANON

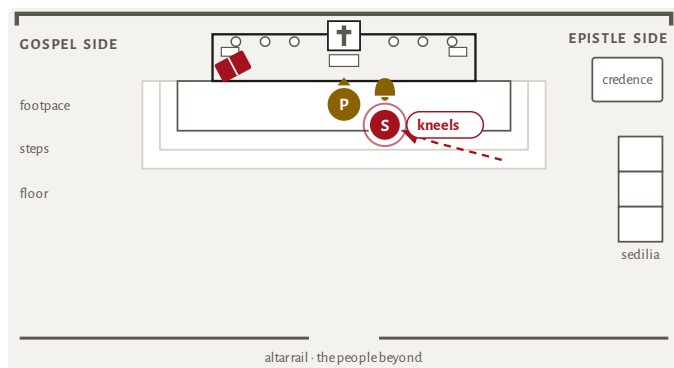
20 Ring the bell at the Sanctus

You kneel on the lowest step at the Epistle end.

1. As the priest says the *Sanctus*, ring the bell. Most churches ring three times, once at each *Sanctus*.
2. Bow; sign yourself with the priest at *Benedíctus qui venit*.

Before 1960 a third candle was lit here and kept burning until after Communion. The 1962 books keep it only where it is already the custom (Code n. 530).

No bell when the Blessed Sacrament is exposed, or at a side-altar Low Mass while a sung Mass is going on at the high altar.



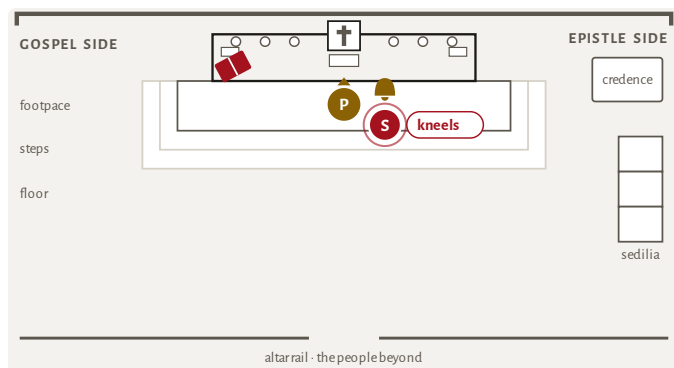
SANCTUS AND CANON

21 Ring the warning bell and go up

You kneel on the edge of the footpace at the priest's right.

1. Shortly before the Consecration, ring the bell once to warn the people. Most churches ring when the priest spreads his hands over the offerings at the *Hanc igitur*.
2. Take the bell and go up, without genuflecting. Kneel on the edge of the footpace at the priest's right, a little behind him.

Fortescue (1920) has you go up when the priest makes the signs of the cross after the *Hanc igitur*, at *Quam oblationem*. The Canons Regular describe the ring as "at the Epiclesis".



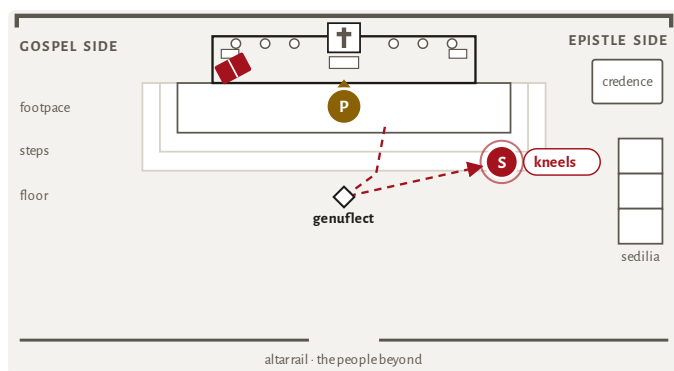
SANCTUS AND CANON

22 Lift the chasuble and ring at the elevations

You kneel on the edge of the footpace at the priest's right.

1. When the priest raises the Host, lift the back hem of his chasuble a little with your left hand: only while he raises it, not while he genuflects, and not too high.
2. Ring the bell with your right hand.
3. Ring once as he genuflects, three times as he raises the Host, once as he genuflects again.
4. Bow low while he genuflects.
5. Do the same when he raises the chalice.

The rubric: "with his left hand he raises the back of the chasuble, so that it does not hinder the celebrant in raising his arms" (Rit. serv. VIII.6).



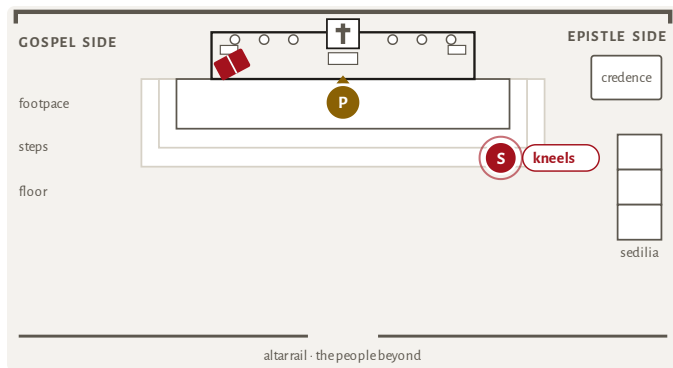
SANCTUS AND CANON

23 Go back to the Epistle side

You kneel on the lowest step at the Epistle end.

1. When the chalice is put down and the priest has genuflected, rise with the bell.
2. Come down to the floor in the middle, genuflect, and go back to kneel at the Epistle end of the lowest step.

Fortescue says you may put the bell back on the credence first.



COMMUNION

24 Answer the Pater noster and the Pax

You kneel on the lowest step at the Epistle end.

1. Answer at the end of the Canon, at the end of the Pater noster, and at the Pax.

PRIEST Per ómnia sæcula sæculórum.

YOU **Amen.**

PRIEST ... Et ne nos ...

YOU **Sed libera nos a malo.**

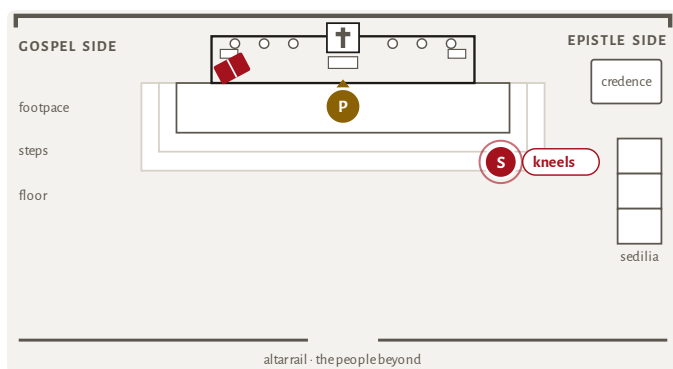
PRIEST Per ómnia sæcula sæculórum.

YOU **Amen.**

PRIEST Pax Dómini sit semper vobíscum.

YOU **Et cum spírítu tuo.**

The rubric gives *Sed libera nos a malo* to the server by name (Rit. serv. X.1).

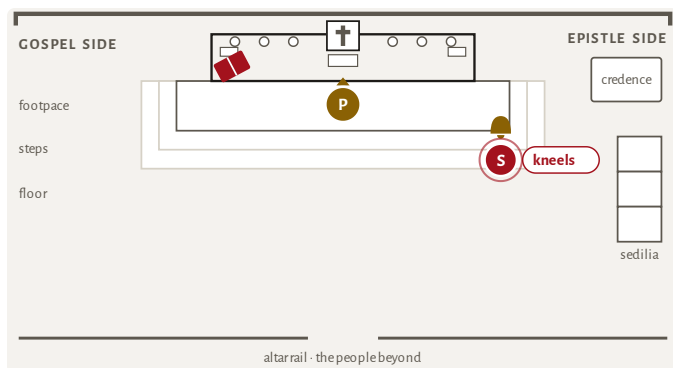


COMMUNION

25 Strike your breast at the Agnus Dei

You kneel on the lowest step at the Epistle end.

1. Bow and strike your breast three times with the priest. Not at a Requiem, where he does not strike his breast.

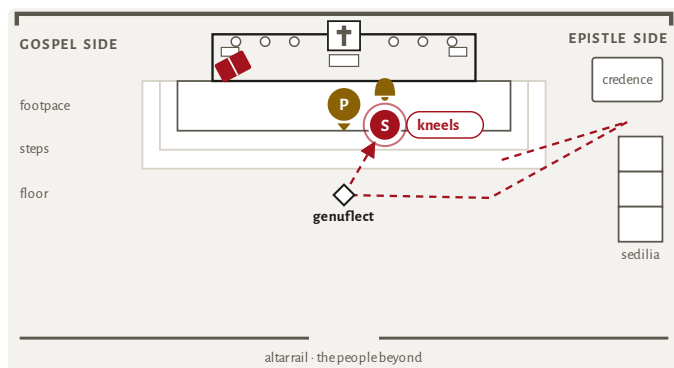


COMMUNION

26 Bow while the priest receives Communion

You kneel on the lowest step at the Epistle end.

1. In many churches you ring once at each of the priest's three *Dómine, non sum dignus*.
2. Bow low while he receives.



COMMUNION

27 Ring for Communion, and receive first

You kneel on the edge of the footpace at the priest's right.

1. If anyone is to receive Communion, ring the bell shortly before to tell them. The 1962 rubric asks for this without fixing the moment, so follow your church.
2. Fetch the paten from the credence, genuflect at the middle, and kneel on the edge of the footpace at the priest's right.
3. You receive first. The priest says the whole formula, *Amen* included, so you do not answer.

PRIEST Ecce Agnus Dei, ecce ...

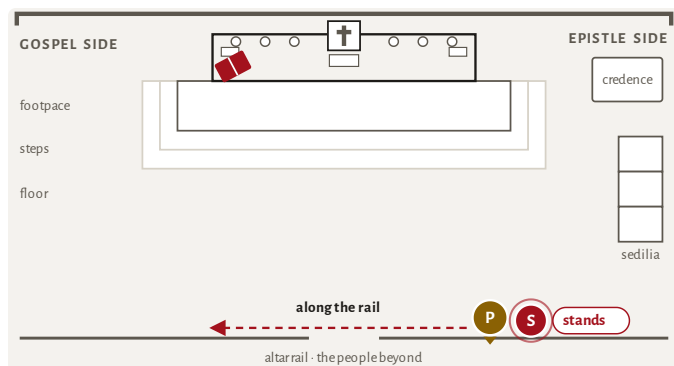
PRIEST Dómine, non sum dignus, ...

PRIEST Corpus Dómini nostri Iesu ...

No Confiteor here in the 1962 rubrics. The priest goes straight to *Ecce Agnus Dei*, "omitting the confession and absolution" (Code n. 503). Many churches still say it. If yours does, say it as at the foot of the altar and answer *Amen* to the priest's *Misereátur vestri* and *Indulgéntiam*. See *Rubric or custom?*

The server receives first (S.R.C. 1074, in Wuest), and may receive kneeling at the edge of the footpace.

Some guides have you say the *Dómine, non sum dignus* quietly with the priest (Canons Regular).



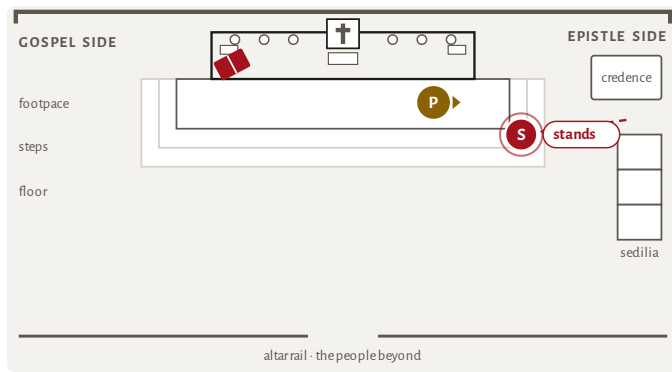
COMMUNION

28 Hold the paten at the rail

You stand at the priest's right at the altar rail.

1. Go down with the priest to the rail. Stand at his right and hold the paten flat under each communicant's chin as he gives Communion.
2. He starts at the Epistle end of the rail (the communicants' right) and works along it.
3. Afterwards give him the paten; he tips any fragments into the chalice. Then take it back to the credence.
4. While the tabernacle is open, kneel when you are not holding the paten.

The paten itself is required (Code n. 528; Rit. serv. X.7). Who holds it is custom: the 1929 instruction had each communicant hold it under their own chin; current guides give it to the server.



COMMUNION

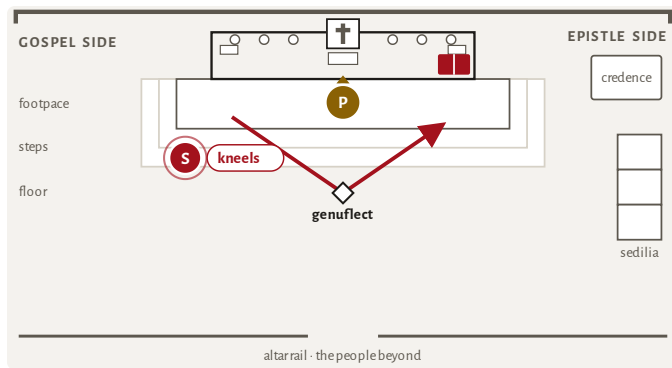
29 Pour the ablutions

You stand on the step below the footpace at the Epistle corner.

1. Take the cruets, wine in your right hand and water in your left, and wait at the Epistle corner on the step below the footpace.
2. First ablution: at the middle of the altar the priest holds the chalice out toward you. Step up and pour wine until he raises the chalice or gives a sign.
3. Second ablution: he comes to the Epistle corner and holds his thumbs and forefingers over the chalice. Pour a little wine, then water, over his fingers until he signals.
4. Bow before and after. No kisses at the ablutions.

If nobody but the priest receives Communion, fetch the cruets as he drinks from the chalice and starts gathering the fragments.

The rubric: he "holds out the chalice over the altar to the server at the Epistle side, who pours wine", then "washes his thumbs and forefingers over the chalice with wine and water" (Rit. serv. X.5).



AFTER COMMUNION TO THE END

30 Carry the missal back to the Epistle side

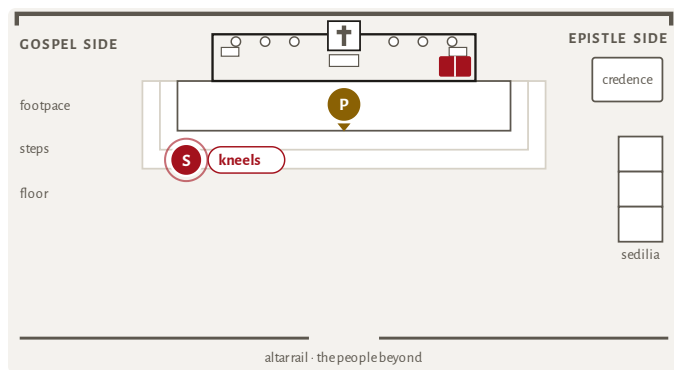
You kneel on the lowest step at the Gospel end.

1. Put the cruets back on the credence. Cross to the Gospel side, genuflecting at the middle, and take the missal.
2. Carry it to the Epistle side, genuflecting again at the middle, and set it square to the front of the altar, as it was at the Introit.
3. Cross back once more, genuflecting, and kneel at the Gospel end of the lowest step. You are opposite the book again.

The rubric: "the missal is carried by the server to the Epistle side and placed as at the Introit. The server kneels by the Gospel side, as at the beginning of Mass" (Rit. serv. XI.1).

Some churches then have you carry the chalice veil to the Gospel side. Fortescue: "At Low Mass there is no serious authority for it"; better to go straight to your place. Do what your church does.

If you can, do all this without stepping on the footpace (Fortescue).



AFTER COMMUNION TO THE END

31 Postcommunion and dismissal

You kneel on the lowest step at the Gospel end.

1. Answer the greeting, and *Amen* after the first and the last Postcommunion.
2. Answer the dismissal.

PRIEST Dóminus vobíscum.

YOU **Et cum spíritu tuo.**

PRIEST ... per ómnia sæcula sæculórum.

YOU **Amen.**

PRIEST Dóminus vobíscum.

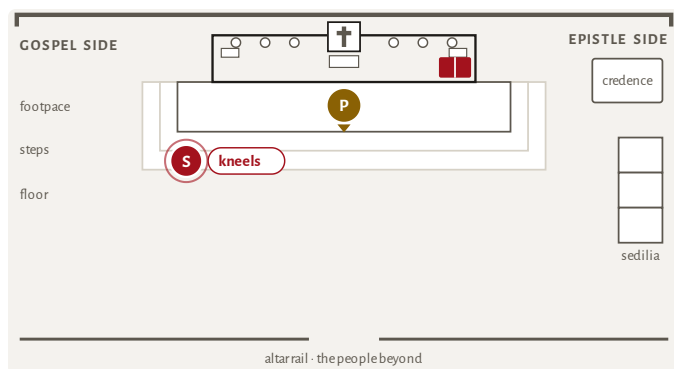
YOU **Et cum spíritu tuo.**

PRIEST Ite, missa est.

YOU **Deo grátias.**

Other dismissals: *Benedicámus Dómino* (answer *Deo grátias*) when a procession follows; *Requiescant in pace* (answer *Amen*) at a Requiem. From the Easter Vigil to the Saturday after Easter the priest adds *allelúia*, *allelúia*, and so do you (Code n. 507).

On Lenten weekdays the priest adds *Orémus. Humiliáte cápita vestra Deo* and a prayer over the people: answer *Amen*.



AFTER COMMUNION TO THE END

32 Kneel for the blessing

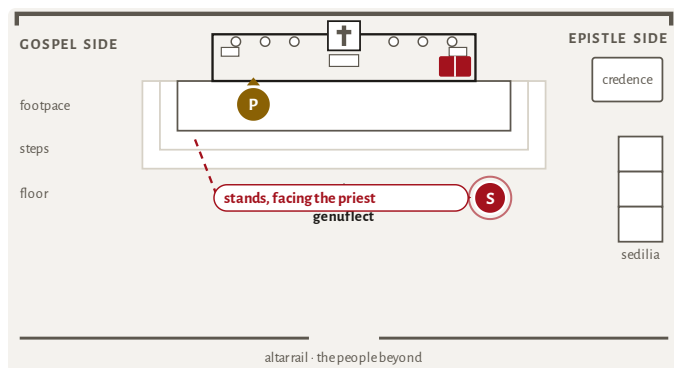
You kneel on the lowest step at the Gospel end.

1. Sign yourself as the priest blesses, and answer *Amen*.
2. Then stand.

PRIEST Benedícat vos omnípotens Deus, ...

YOU **Amen.**

No blessing at a Requiem or after *Benedicámus Dómino* (Code n. 508). At a Requiem you do not kneel for it, since there is none.



AFTER COMMUNION TO THE END

33 The Last Gospel

You stand on the floor at the Epistle corner.

1. Stand at the Gospel side for the opening. Answer, and make the three small crosses with the priest.
2. Cross to the Epistle side, genuflecting at the middle, and stand turned toward the priest.
3. Genuflect with him at *Et Verbum caro factum est*.
4. At the end answer *Deo grátias*.

PRIEST Dóminus vobíscum.

YOU **Et cum spírítu tuo.**

PRIEST ✠ Inítium sancti Evangélii secúndum Ioánnem.

YOU **Glória tibi, Dómine.**

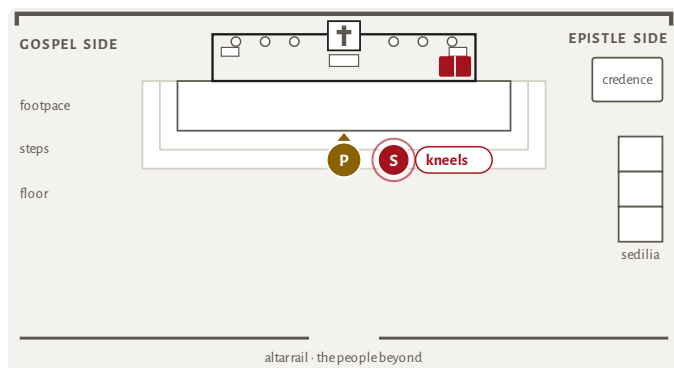
PRIEST *at the end of the Last Gospel*

YOU **Deo grátias.**

The rubric: "when it is finished, the server, standing at the Epistle side, answers *Deo grátias*" (Rit. serv. XII.1).

Since 1960 the Last Gospel is always the opening of St John, except at Palm Sunday Masses said without the procession, which have their own. It is left out when a procession follows, at the third Mass of Christmas, at the Palm Sunday Mass after the procession, at the Easter Vigil, and when the Absolution follows a Requiem (Code nn. 509–510).

Before 1960 many days had a proper Last Gospel, and you carried the missal back to the Gospel side for it. In the 1962 books that can only happen on Palm Sunday.



AFTER COMMUNION TO THE END

34 Prayers after Low Mass

You kneel on the lowest step at the priest's right.

1. Kneel on the lowest step at the priest's right. (Fortescue: on the lowest step at the Epistle side.)
2. Hand him the prayer card if he needs it, and take it back afterwards.
3. Answer the Hail Marys and say the rest with him. The Hail Mary is said three times, and so is the invocation of the Sacred Heart.

PRIEST Ave Maria, gratia plena, ...

YOU **Sancta Maria, Mater Dei, ora pro nobis peccatoribus, nunc et in hora mortis nostrae. Amen.** (three times)

ALL Salve Regina, Mater misericordiae; vita, dulcedo et spes nostra, salve. Ad te clamamus, exsules filii Evae. Ad te suspiramus, gementes et flentes in hac lacrimarum valle. Eia ergo, advocata nostra, illos tuos misericordes oculos ad nos converte. Et Iesum, benedictum fructum ventris tui, nobis, post hoc exsilium, ostende. O clemens, o pia, o dulcis Virgo Maria.

PRIEST Ora pro nobis, sancta Dei Genetrix.

YOU **Ut digni efficiamur promissionibus Christi.**

PRIEST Oremus. Deus, refugium nostrum ...

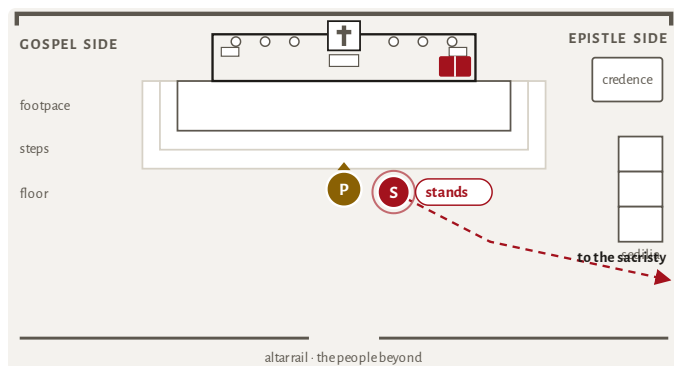
YOU **Amen.**

ALL Sancte Michael Archangele, defende nos in proelio; contra nequitiam et insidias diaboli esto praesidium. Imperet illi Deus, supplices deprecamur: tuque, Princeps militiae caelestis, Satanam aliosque spiritus malignos, qui ad perditionem animarum pervagantur in mundo, divina virtute in infernum detrude. Amen.

PRIEST Cor Iesu sacratissimum.

YOU **Miserere nobis.** (three times)

These prayers were never part of the Missal. Decrees from 1884 to 1930 attached them to Low Mass; they could be left out in several cases (after a sermon, or when Benediction or another rite follows), and *Inter Oecumenici* suppressed them from 7 March 1965. Communities using the 1962 books still say them, in Latin or in English. The Latin here is printed without accent marks because the two sources mark them differently.



AFTER COMMUNION TO THE END

35 Lead the priest back to the sacristy

You stand at the priest's right, at the foot of the altar.

1. Fetch the biretta. When the priest comes down with the chalice, genuflect with him on the floor.
2. Hand him the biretta: kiss the biretta first, then his hand.
3. Walk in front of him to the sacristy, carrying the missal if you brought it in.
4. In the sacristy bow with him to the cross and help him unvest. Then put out the candles, the Gospel side first, and clear the credence.

Customs after Mass vary: the priest may bless you; in some places he says *Prosit* and you answer *Pro omnibus et singulis*.

Practice differs a little from church to church: where your priest or MC does it differently, do it that way. From *Serving the Latin Mass*, <https://mikeygabmiller.github.io/Serving/>, where every instruction carries its source.